

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8b-26yx-cmsv
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-8056

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

As a professional artist and as a science educator, I am commenting first and foremost, that the colloquially called A.I. technologies, such as Dall-E and ChatGPT are both harmful to myself and other artists and any development in these areas must be done within tight regulations with plenty of oversight.

As a person who works closely with the sciences, one of the things I am most concerned about is the spreading of harmful misinformation. Some of it tangential, but much of it very real. A.I. regularly gives wrong information; everything from the number of snake bites per year in the US to labeling deadly plants as safe and edible.

This information not only harms our ability to educate the public about our natural world, history, and current events, it puts their lives in danger.

Innocuous but deadly fungi like Destroying Angels could very easily be eaten by someone relying on A.I. to identify it. And in fact, it appears to already be happening:

<https://gizmodo.com/ai-chatbot-joins-mushroom-hunters-group-immediately-encourages-them-to-cook-dangerous-mushroom-2000523863>

There are books on Amazon.com, completely ai-generated from an author that doesn't exist. Platforming ai will eventually kill someone.

As an artist, my work has been directly affected by the use of ai. Much of my work comes from small commissions. Works that cost at or around \$500. Since the rise in popularity of Dall-E and Midjourney, I have seen those commissions all but evaporate.

As an artist and a student of art history, I am deeply worried about what this will do to the American people, culturally.

If we truly strive to be the shining city on the hill, then how can we settle for what is effectively, just barely good enough? Are we truly going to throw away human artistry, endeavor, and effort for something as ephemeral as 'content' that only sort of meets the idea a person is trying to translate into reality?

Are we going to flush all those jobs down the toilet, collapsing industries.

What is the point of developing these tools when they're being used to replace some of the few labors human beings strive for?

Things we measure intelligence and cultural impact by. Is this not of dire import to the United States?

As they take so many tries, create wrong or incorrect information, and are at the mercy of stolen materials; these technologies are also inefficient. Time and time again, I have seen copy editors replaced with ai, only to be hired in lesser paying, temporary positions, to correct the mistakes the bot made.

Would it not have been faster simply to hire a human to do copy?

These models use incredible amounts of power and until we have an effective way to power our homes, tech, and vehicles, this is just another strain.

The combination will inevitably cost both businesses and consumers more money.

I must also reiterate, that the models, impressive as they are, only got that way through theft. Hundreds of thousands of hours of labor, millions of images and books and documents. All stolen to be sold back to us as an inferior product.

Thus far, this is a product of fraud and theft. Our work and livelihoods taken without compensation and repackaged.

If truly we live in a free market under capitalism, this cannot be allowed to continue.

How can we, the producers in the ecology of the free-market protect ourselves from the theft of our intellectual property if our own government will not stand on our side? This is a blatant violation of copyright.

AI has proven not to be profitable. The push for it is a feeble attempt for a return on investment that simply does not exist. Like the Ivanpah Solar Power Facility in Nevada, it should be shuttered, like that facility, there are simply better options available, those panels proved to be ineffective, AI in its current form has proven to be a useless power-guzzling waste of time. The effort was valiant perhaps, impressive even, but ultimately not worth continuing with consideration to the harm it does both to us as working Americans and to our culture.